

# December 2026 link proposals — at a glance

All 10 proposals against today’s link — the three shortlisted ones marked ★ — sorted by December rules met, then avoidable fatigue warnings, then by name; a proposal that breaks a hard limit cannot be run as it stands and comes last. Every figure is worked out from the rota by the Marylebone Roster app. Staffing levels and Sunday cover confirmed verbally (29 Sep 2026); the 26-line link, 5 cover weeks and a ceiling of 219 contracted days a year set on 1 Oct 2026.

| Proposal · code                          | December rules met | Avoidable fatigue warnings§ | Most days in a row§ | Full weekends off                                | Shortest fixed-duty rest | Shift times | Days a year* | Heaviest week, Mon–Sat | Weeks on one turn | Weeks mixing earlies and lates | Week-to-week change of start | Finishes 23:00+ a year† |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------|--------------|------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Today’s link 20 weeks                    | 4 of 9             | 4 up to 5§                  | 7 up to 9§          | 4 in 20 about 10 a year · 7 weeks apart at most  | 12h 30m                  | 18          | 219.0        | 43h 50m                | 7 of 16           | 7                              | 4h 00m                       | 39                      |
| ★ shortlisted<br>Even Keel EK-26-H1      | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 5 up to 6§          | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most  | 14h 35m                  | 15 (7 new)  | 218.6        | 41h 30m                | 18 of 21          | 1                              | 1h 16m                       | 44                      |
| Fine Tune FT-26-H1                       | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 5 up to 6§          | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most  | 14h 35m                  | 15 (7 new)  | 218.6        | 41h 30m                | 16 of 21          | 1                              | 1h 09m                       | 44                      |
| Long Break LB-26-F1                      | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 6                   | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most  | 14h 20m                  | 15 (6 new)  | 218.6        | 42h 00m                | 16 of 21          | 0                              | 1h 44m                       | 42                      |
| ★ shortlisted<br>Second Edition SE-26-F1 | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 6                   | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most  | 14h 20m                  | 15 (6 new)  | 218.6        | 42h 00m                | 18 of 21          | 0                              | 1h 01m                       | 42                      |
| Second Gear SG-26-H1                     | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 5 up to 6§          | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most  | 14h 35m                  | 15 (7 new)  | 218.6        | 41h 30m                | 16 of 21          | 2                              | 1h 25m                       | 44                      |
| Second Look SL-26-G3                     | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 6                   | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most  | 14h 20m                  | 14 (6 new)  | 218.6        | 43h 40m                | 15 of 21          | 1                              | 1h 30m                       | 42                      |
| Second Nature SN-26-F2                   | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 6                   | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 10 weeks apart at most | 14h 20m                  | 15 (6 new)  | 218.6        | 43h 40m                | 15 of 21          | 2                              | 1h 28m                       | 42                      |
| Second Sight SS-26-F1                    | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 6                   | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most  | 14h 20m                  | 15 (6 new)  | 218.6        | 42h 00m                | 16 of 21          | 0                              | 1h 55m                       | 42                      |
| Second Wind SW-26-F1                     | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 6                   | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most  | 14h 20m                  | 15 (6 new)  | 218.6        | 42h 30m                | 16 of 21          | 4                              | 2h 01m                       | 42                      |
| ★ shortlisted<br>Short Run SR-26-F1      | 9 of 9             | 0                           | 5 up to 6§          | 7 in 26 about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most  | 14h 20m                  | 15 (6 new)  | 218.6        | 42h 30m                | 18 of 21          | 0                              | 1h 13m                       | 42                      |

\* Monday to Saturday, with a cover week counted as 4 days (Sundays are overtime and left out). † Each person, on average across the whole link, Sundays included; cover-week duties are not known yet and are left out. “Shift times” counts different start–finish times; “new” means nobody works that time today. || One shift time Monday to Friday and no switch between earlies and lates in the week. The week-to-week change is the average move of the start time from one week to the next. § On the duties the rota fixes, the cover weeks left out for the proposal and today alike; “up to” is the worst place a cover week’s four duties could fall. Avoidable fatigue warnings come from the ORR’s good-practice list plus rail-industry checks, leaving out the two that come with every weekly link — reported, never pass or fail. Full detail for each proposal is in its own eight-page sheet; the rules themselves are in links-26-rules.pdf.